establish trust in that larger system. In blockchain programming, you don’t replace an existing system; you enhance it with code for trust intermediation through validation and verification.

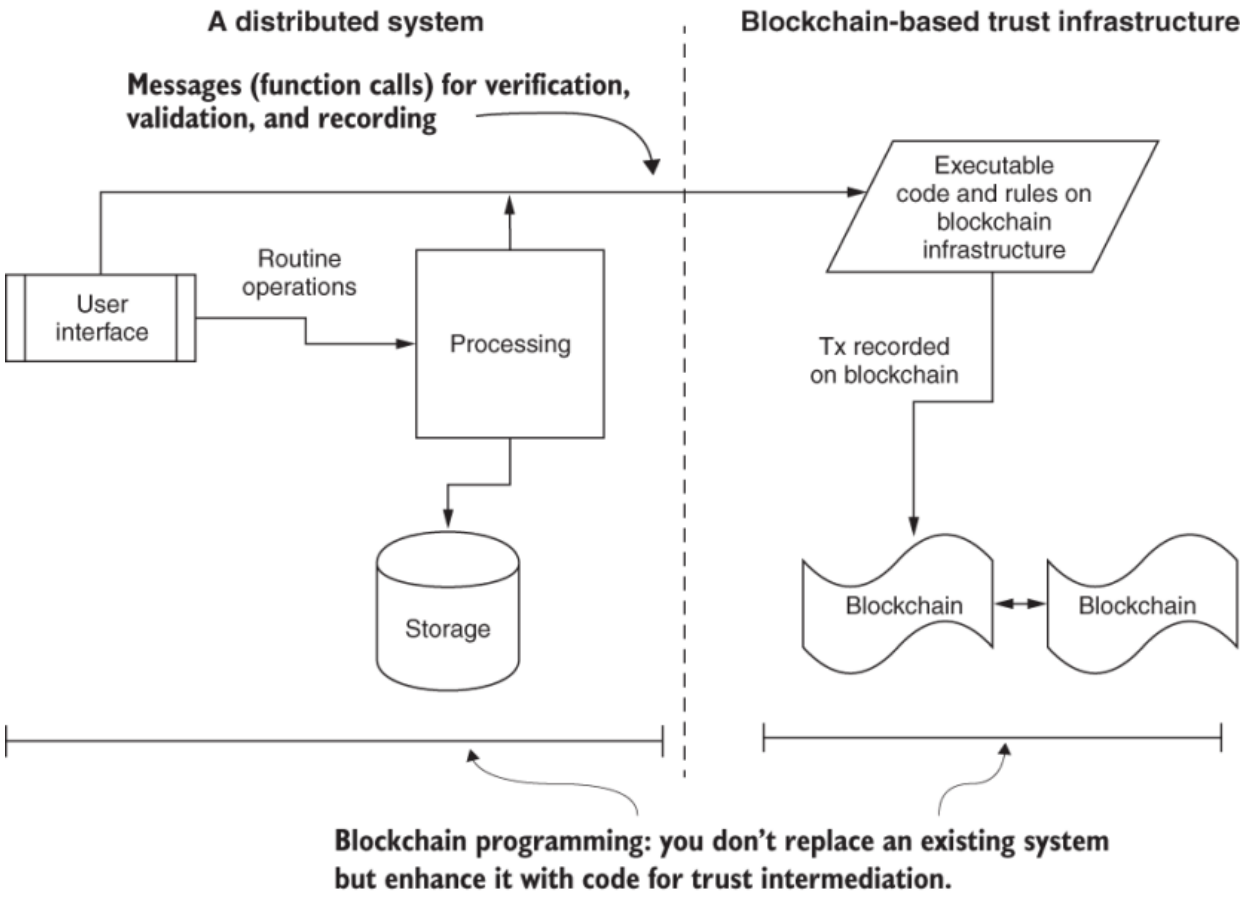


Figure 1.3 Blockchain programming context

To help you further understand blockchain programming, let’s examine the blockchain stacks for Bitcoin and Ethereum, shown in figure 1.4. These stacks represent the two models of blockchain in its short history. Bitcoin has only the wallet application, whereas Ethereum features programmable code called smart contracts (about which you’ll learn more in chapters 2-4).